SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

ONLINE REVIEWS AND HOTEL BOOKING INTENTION IN BUTUAN CITY

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CHAPTER I

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the Study

Online reviews serve as feedback or ratings that guests post on social media to share their opinions of a product, service, or place. People now use websites and social media to share their experiences with others, rather than connecting in person, which is called E-WOM (Electronic Word of Mouth). Hotels boost their image through positive online reviews; positive reviews can attract potential guests, while negative reviews can discourage them and affect the hotel's public image. In the Philippines, where tourism plays a pivotal role in the economy, online platforms such as TripAdvisor, Booking.com, Facebook Marketplace and other websites have changed how travelers choose accommodations. To help shoppers with their purchases, online reviews serve as a crucial marketing tool, providing concrete consumer insights (Lim et al., 2022). Despite the growing value of online reviews, Butuan City hotels fail to maximize them as marketing and management resources.

Many International studies consistently show that online reviews play a crucial role in shaping hotel booking decisions, as guests increasingly rely on user-generated content to evaluate hotel credibility, value, and service quality. Trust in online reviews, their perceived usefulness, and frequent exposure to them have emerged as key determinants of booking behavior (Ke et al., 2025). In this sense, online reviews function not merely as information sources but as evaluative mechanisms that influence consumer confidence and decision-making. Supporting this, Kajornatthapol et al. (2024) demonstrated that online reviews

directly enhance guests' trust in hotels and their perceived value, thereby strengthening booking intentions. The influence of reviews is largely driven by their credibility, volume, and quality, as travelers are more likely to rely on numerous, consistent, and credible reviews when selecting accommodations (Huseynov & Güler, 2021; García-De-blanes-sebastián et al., 2024). Review quality, particularly length, tone, and emotional appeal also shapes perceptions, with detailed and positively framed reviews enhancing perceived hotel quality and value, while negative reviews related to hygiene, service attitude, or infrastructure significantly discourage bookings (Deng & Tu, 2023; Y. Chen et al., 2024). However, an excessive number of overly positive reviews may raise skepticism, indicating that authenticity and balance are essential for maintaining consumer trust (Suwal et al., 2025). In addition, hotels that actively manage online engagement and platform reliability further strengthen the persuasive impact of reviews, as transparent content, image-supported reviews, and reliable booking systems enhance user satisfaction and booking likelihood (Sumarjan et al., 2024a; Lim et al., 2022; Ahmad & Gandhi, 2023; Zhang et al., 2022).

In the Philippine context, findings generally align with international evidence while offering localized insights into traveler behavior. Filipino travelers place strong importance on recent, frequent, local, and positive reviews, which increase confidence and willingness to book hotels (Javier, 2025). Platforms such as Agoda are commonly preferred due to their user-friendly interfaces and comprehensive hotel information, enabling faster and more informed booking decisions (Emmanuel Decena & Delfin, 2022). Moreover, hotels that actively respond to guest feedback and maintain high-quality facilities foster satisfaction, repeat visits, and customer

loyalty, reinforcing the value of online engagement in the local hospitality industry (GADAT et al., 2023; Atienza & Ylagan, 2025). Nevertheless, students and young travelers, despite their heavy reliance on online reviews, remain cautious about review credibility, underscoring the importance of trustworthy and authentic online content (Lucero et al., 2025). Despite these national-level findings, limited attention has been given to how hotels in Butuan City specifically utilize online reviews as a strategic tool to influence booking intentions.

This study will examine how online reviews influence hotel booking intentions in Butuan City. Online reviews, perceived price, and website trust are essential factors affecting how guests decide to book hotels online, as noted by Amrisha Augustine and Hayat Adnan (2025). Perceived price reflects how guests evaluate the value and cost of hotel rooms, while website trust pertains to the credibility, reliability, and security of online booking platforms—both influencing guests' willingness to book. Online reviews also help travelers assess hotel quality and service, with positive reviews increasing feelings of safety and encouraging reservations. Additionally, Arniel Jr. Edmedulan (2025) emphasizes that booking intention is shaped by components such as Perceived Value, Perceived Quality, and Risk Perception, which are influenced by the information guests gather from online reviews. Together, these studies highlight the important role of online reviews in shaping consumers' evaluations and decisions when booking hotels in Butuan City.

Online reviews have become an important source of information for tourists when choosing hotels, yet there is limited research on how these reviews influence booking intentions in Butuan City. As travelers increasingly rely on online comments, ratings, and website

information to assess a hotel's value, quality, and safety, many local hotels still do not use online platforms effectively or manage guest feedback consistently. This creates a gap between travelers' decision-making habits and the digital practices of hotels in the city. To address this, the study examines how demographic factors, perceived price, website trust, and online reviews affect the booking intentions of tourists in Butuan City. The findings aim to provide hotels with insights that can help improve their online presence, strengthen marketing strategies, and support the development of the local tourism industry.

This study will help hotels in Butuan City understand the importance of online reviews in influencing hotel booking intentions within a growing yet digitally uneven tourism market. As an emerging commercial and tourism hub in the Caraga Region, Butuan City will continue to receive a steady flow of business and leisure travelers; however, many local hotels will still be observed to underutilize online customer reviews and lack structured review management strategies compared to more established tourist destinations. Travelers will increasingly rely on online reviews to assess hotel value, pricing fairness, service quality, and website credibility, making it essential to examine how these factors will affect booking decisions in the local context. The findings will support the Butuan City Local Government Unit (LGU) in developing tourism programs that enhance digital adoption and online reputation management among hotels. Additionally, the results will benefit the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management (CTHM) by serving as a reference for instruction, research, and curriculum enhancement, while this study will address a clear local research gap and will contribute to sustainable tourism growth in Butuan City.

Theoretical Framework

The research will rely on the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) proposed by Icek Ajzen, in which attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control will influence travelers' intention to book a hotel. In the research study to be conducted, perceived price and website trust will influence the attitude of tourists toward booking a hotel online. When hotel prices will be reasonable and the website will be trustworthy, the likelihood of developing a positive attitude will increase. Online reviews will influence subjective norms, as the views of fellow travelers expressed online, as well as those of individuals close to the tourist, will affect the decision to book a hotel online. On the other hand, perceived behavioral control will influence the ease of comparing prices, reading reviews, and completing the process of booking a hotel online.

The research will also be guided by the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) developed by Fred Davis, which will explain the acceptance of online booking systems among travelers by considering the determinants of perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use. Online reviews will serve as enhancers of perceived usefulness by providing information that will help travelers assess service quality and price fairness on online booking platforms. Website trust and the ease of use of online booking systems will act as enablers of perceived ease of use, thereby increasing travelers' confidence in conducting online booking transactions.

Taken collectively, both theories will provide a strong foundation for the research study, as they will explain how perceived price, website trust, and online reviews will influence

attitudinal, social, and technological perspectives of travelers. These theories will demonstrate that intentions to book a hotel room will be shaped not only by personal evaluations but also by social feedback and confidence in technology.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

This chapter will present related literature that will support the examination of the relationship between online reviews and hotel booking intentions, defined as travelers' likelihood of reserving accommodation based on information obtained from online platforms. As hotel booking activities are expected to continue shifting toward digital environments, online reviews are anticipated to function as a major form of electronic word-of-mouth influencing travelers' decision-making processes. Existing studies will be examined to show how online reviews are expected to shape perceptions of hotel quality, credibility, and value, thereby reducing uncertainty and perceived risk in online bookings. Positive online reviews are likely to enhance trust and strengthen booking intentions, whereas negative reviews may discourage potential guests from making reservations. Moreover, variations in booking intentions are expected across demographic characteristics such as age, sex, educational attainment, and occupation, which may influence how travelers interpret and utilize online reviews. In the context of Butuan City, this review will provide a foundation for understanding the role of online reviews in shaping hotel booking intentions and will establish the relevance of the present study to the hospitality industry.

Age

Age is essential because fraudulent transactions, such as fake bookings and identity theft, pose significant problems in the hotel industry. As a result, guest verification at the time of hotel booking includes age verification. It was also determined that (Chubchuwong, 2022) found that convenience in making online reservations was critical to the younger generation than to people aged 18-24 and 25-39 years old. Guetal (2024) states that fraudulent online reservations result in significant losses for hotels and even harm their brand reputation. Their study lists authentication as one of the methods that help follow up on suspicious activities and verify the client's information. Age verification would help prevent fraudulent reservations and help retain guests' trust in online booking systems. In this regard, findings have also established that age influences decision-making on both the consumer and brand sides (Ezzaouia & Bulchand-Gidumal, 2020).

On the other hand, studies will examine consumer profiles and will find that age distinguishes how people evaluate, review content, and make reservation decisions (Ciocoiu et al., 2024).Younger consumers would be concerned about the tone, while older consumers would be interested in detailed information across a greater volume of reviews. Also, further research will examine fraud victimization among older adults, focusing on age-related differences in susceptibility and trust perceptions in online environments (Shang et al., 2022). With higher web reservations, elderly clients can become more responsive to reserving for themselves, while for young clients, distance and price elasticity can be the determining factors. In another study, the authors find that demographic variables such as age, gender, and family

income are significant in describing tourists' online hotel reservation behavior (Ngoc Kim & Trong Tien BUI, 2022). Therefore, implementing age verification or demographic checks in their online reservation systems could help hotels prevent false or fraudulent bookings. Age plays a critical role in how people use online hotel booking systems. Younger users are usually confident with digital booking tools, while older users tend to focus on trust and security when making reservations (Al-Kateb & Alzyoud, 2024). Age also matters more when choosing hotel websites than when booking through offline channels (Simanjuntak & Sakti, 2023). These studies show that age is a critical factor in hotel reservations, influencing how customers judge credibility and helping hotels reduce fraud or booking errors through age-based verification.

Sex

Sex, or biological differences between men and women, will keep dictating how people make online choices to book hotels. Males and females differ in how they analyze risk and respond to different types of Internet feedback. The value of internet information varies by sex; people differ in how much they trust the input of men and women (Sikdar et al., 2022). According to Ravula et al. (2023), females are more likely to believe and be influenced by online feedback. In contrast, male consumers tend to make their choices quickly without delving into the details of the input. It means that salience related to sex is going to be very important as far as knowing how people interpret online information when booking hotels.

The social and visual elements of booking sites will also influence users differently according to gender. For instance, Bai et al. (2024) indicate that women are likely to book rooms on Airbnb when the hosts' faces are visible. In contrast, men were less influenced by such cues,

further indicating that minor design elements affect decision-making differently for men and women. Turning to hotel preferences, Ali et al. (2021) extend prior research in order to demonstrate that women are likely to care about credible and effective cues. In contrast, men are likely to care about rational and functional cues. (E. E. K. Kim et al., 2025) found that women read reviews carefully to avoid risks or poor service, and men focus on convenience and saving money. These results show that visual design, content, and gender all shape how much people trust and use booking sites.

Sex is likely to remain a key factor in predicting how people book hotels online. Some travelers may seek complete and accurate information, while others may focus on cost and functionality. By understanding these differences, hotels in Butuan City can create marketing strategies that appeal to a wide range of guests. Offering clear information, reliable feedback, and balanced images can help build trust with customers. Future research will help confirm these findings. When hotels address the varied needs of their guests, they can build credibility and encourage confident online bookings from a diverse audience.

Educational Level

Education plays a role in how people understand and use digital information, especially in online hotel reviews. Education enhances digital literacy, critical analysis, and trust in online information. It comes in handy for travelers using online reviews to book a hotel room. While most studies treat education as demographic data, some do not assess its influence on online reviews regarding booking intentions. In one such study, highly educated individuals in Thailand demonstrated better judgment. It also affirms that education empowers individuals to critically

evaluate online content (Kajornatthapol et al., 2024b). In this study, website quality, social presence, and e-trust were considered, while education was a controlled variable. It was established that education was not a direct predictor of booking intentions. However, it influenced participants' perceived capability to evaluate information credibility, which affected their confidence in decision-making (Xue et al., 2020). Similarly, Kim & Han (2022) examined hotel choice during the COVID-19 pandemic. They found that higher education respondents responded more favorably towards online communication and information from hotels regarding cleanliness.

Various studies have further shown that there is an association between learning and online behavior of engagement. That association has been recorded by Llorens-Marin et al. (2023). Future research aims to develop a predictive model to examine the impact of website quality and online reviews on users' behavior and intention to book. Individuals with higher educational attainment will believe in the effectiveness of the online system and generally view reviews as accurate (Salameh et al., 2022). However, there has been little direct testing of how education alters the relationship between online reviews and booking intentions. It is a topic that warrants further investigation, particularly in Butuan, where educational attainment varies considerably.

Some studies have examined the influence of education on factors that determine booking, such as trust and site quality. Website quality, social interaction, and trust were the primary drivers of booking decisions found. Education was not an explanatory factor, but it was still considered to contribute to forming impressions of online credibility (Amin et al., 2021). In

the same way, individuals with higher levels of education were more likely to make judicious, well-informed booking choices based on online reviews related to hygiene and safety, despite education not having a direct impact on booking intentions (Ju & Jang, 2023). These analyses propose that education can affect how travelers read and respond to online reviews, even if this is secondary to the research's primary focus.

Occupation

Occupation is one factor that affects how people perceive and use online reviews when selecting a hotel. People with a steady job, or rather a better-paying employment opportunity, would be highly dependent on online reviews when sealing the deal on their accommodation, as they have the time and mind to make good comparisons. Individuals with regular employment and greater financial capacity also show greater confidence when using online booking websites or mobile applications, as they are digitally literate. On this basis, Lata (2021) included occupation as an important variable that impacts both the extent to which consumers trust an online booking platform and whether they will book a reservation. Second, the nature of an individual's work will determine their analytical review style. Busy professionals and business travelers prefer to pay more attention to depth, reliability, and accuracy in what they read. These patterns indicate that occupation can influence cognitive responses to online information and, in turn, directly influence booking intention. The hypothesis is adopted from (Ali et al., 2021).

Occupation will be a critical aspect in developing an understanding of online traveler behavior. Occupation may influence how reviews are assessed, with travelers from different

occupational backgrounds receiving different ratings, given their varied work experiences and travel motivations (Zheng et al., 2023). Business travelers focus mainly on the reliability and quality of services as portrayed in the reviews. The details they are more interested in include consistency, staff professionalism, and better facilities. In contrast, leisure travelers are more interested in comfort, affordability, and overall enjoyment (Cho et al., 2024). These tendencies will highlight that the occupational category of travelers can determine what they value most in online reviews and how these perceptions influence their booking decisions.

Occupation will also determine the outlook of guests and that of hotel employees. Employee work-related stress and job satisfaction are likely to affect service performance, which, in turn, would be reflected in online reviews (Wen et al., 2022). Certainly, if working conditions are poor or employees are burnt out, service will definitely be affected, and hence poor reviews may dampen bookings. In support, Xia et al. (2023) discussed how employee-written reviews can reflect actual workplace conditions, which, in turn, shape guests' perceptions and trust in a hotel's reputation. Occupation influences how travelers write reviews after their stay. Business travelers and government employees often focus on efficiency, reliability, and professionalism in giving feedback. On the other hand, leisure travelers are most likely to speak about the relaxation and comfort seen and the affordability of the services offered during their stay (Nicolau et al., 2025). These variations in review style mean that occupation shows different travel segments based on the patterns they use in online review systems and the aspects emphasized therein (Ciocoiu et al., 2024).

According to (Román et al., 2024), professionals will generally trust a review with detailed, real-world experience, while other groups may be less critical in assessing its quality. A person's occupation determines how travelers perceive, trust, and respond to online reviews. It affects both how people read reviews and how they write them, influencing overall booking behavior. A traveler's job background will influence how they assess the information provided by the hotel, what aspects they consider significant, and what they believe online. This occupational difference will be highly significant at Butuan City, which receives a considerable number of visitors for work or business-related travel. This insight into the impact of occupation can help hotels create more effective marketing strategies and build greater credibility, thereby ensuring higher online booking rates.

Perceived Price

Perceived price can influence how consumers evaluate the value of hotel services and whether to make a reservation, particularly through online reviews. Perceived price transcends the monetary value and describes the way consumers determine whether a price is acceptable, reasonable, or worth paying. When customers come across favorable reviews that align with fair or reasonable prices, they will gain greater confidence in booking. On the other hand, where online reviews indicate that the prices are excessive for the quality delivered, booking intentions will decline.

Perceived price helps connect online reviews with booking decisions by allowing travelers in Butuan City to see hotel deals as fair, reasonable, and worth their money. The perceived price is a mental trigger in determining how credible and competitive an

accommodation is. Customers are likely to make reservations in those hotels that show transparency in their prices and rates, and also have good reviews from previous customers. Perceived price also plays a vital role in customer satisfaction and likelihood of booking, as it reveals the balance between reason and emotion guiding the choices of travelers. (Sumarjan et al., 2024b) states that perceived price indicates how much the tourists will pay for a hotel room and is crucial factor that significantly shapes their decision to book. They insisted that tourists will book when they perceive that the price is appropriate and proportional to the value anticipated. In a competitive market, hotels that offer lower or additional reasonable prices can gain an advantage and attract extra guests, rather than sticking to one fixed price

The perceived price refers to customers' subjective feelings of the price paid for an online purchase Typically, the fairness and value of a product or service are determined by customers in relation to the quality and expected benefits. (Y. F. Chen et al., 2023) argue that when customers perceive that the prices they are being offered are better than those offered to others, then that is perceived as fair, and thus they may reserve a hotel. Similarly, Thi et al. (2020) state that price also has a strong positive effect on online hotel booking intentions, as customers often see it as a key indicator of fairness and quality when deciding whether to book. The perceived price value was found to positively and significantly influence behavioral intention to adopt mobile hotel booking (Mohamad et al., 2021).

Perceived price is classified according to the difference between observed and expected prices. When the result is positive, the price is classified into perceived price gain, and when the effect is negative, it is classified into perceived price loss (Christin & Nugraha, 2023).

The study showed that price plays a significant role as a sign of value for money, influencing whether consumers decide to book or not. When hotel prices are reasonable and reflect what the customer expects, travelers are extremely likely to complete their online bookings. Their findings show that increased price transparency decreases the perceived price, increases trust and perceived value, and consequently increases purchase intention.

For this study, perceived price is an indicator of customers' perceptions of honesty, simplicity, and fairness in online hotel prices when making online reservations, and is a determinant of their trust and willingness to complete a booking. It also directly affects how likely they are to book hotel stays or buy travel packages online. Price is a key factor in the decision-making process as customers evaluate the worthiness of products or services (Thanatnun Anutatawaykin et al., 2023). Studies show that the way prices are set and presented online can greatly shape how travelers perceive whether a hotel is affordable and reasonably priced.

Website Trust

Website trust is built through positive online reviews, reliable information, and regular communication. Such approaches have been highly effective in fostering consumer confidence. A site that is visually appealing and easily accessible, with information that is available and relevant, contributes significantly to perceived credibility. The way the site looks and navigates is significant in establishing this trust. When a website is attractive, easy to use, and displays relevant information, users are likely to trust it. (Guo et al., 2023) highlighted that proper navigation and design of information increase usability and satisfaction, ultimately leading to

higher user loyalty. Likewise, if online markets are transparent and adopt explicit regulations for rating, then consumer confidence is strengthened (Peña-García et al., 2024) Repeated communication and trustworthy website policies also help to build long-term confidence, according to (Cano et al., 2022). Online reviews are also a principal determinant of website trust. Reviews help consumers to establish the credibility of the product and then the platform. Users trust the website as it contains a lot of ratings, reviews, and descriptive comments (Sung et al., 2023). Price is not the important thing in the hospitality industry, while trust in online reviews can strongly influence travelers to intend to book the accommodation.

Equally, young consumers are confident in online reviews. However, some have not developed the full potential in spotting false or fabricated content, leading to a gradual erosion of confidence in the sites over time (Lucero et al., 2025). Therefore, it is for review sites to adopt verification mechanisms and monitoring procedures that validate the authenticity of reviews to safeguard users against misinformation. This is what Zelenka et al. (2021) establish in their work. The overall quality and brand reputation of websites also have direct impacts on user trust. In the view of (Baki, 2020), it has been proved that reputation, security, and ease of use are important factors that determine customers' confidence toward online accommodation reservation websites. If the websites are up to date, possess secure payment formats, and are easy to navigate, users will feel more secure and satisfied. Good website content also plays a part; as (Cheng et al., 2023) identify, hotels that have a full and well-categorized online information store appear to be more trustworthy, having anticipated possible visitors. Trust and satisfaction are interactive in both ways: when users have feelings of confidence in a website,

further reinforcement of such feelings of satisfaction is made by the site's design and usability, and vice versa. Websites that involve clear safety measures, have effective regulation of their review system, and maintain transparency enhance user confidence, as (Peña-García et al., 2024) have stated. Overall, in summary, trust from the website will be built under the common action of secure design, trustworthy information, real reviewing, and communication frequency, all encouraging users to confidently interact with online platforms.

Online Reviews

Online reviews have become a key aspect of the decision-making process for hospitality workers, functioning as electronic word of mouth, helping travelers assess a hotel's quality, service, and value. Aliyah et al. (2025) established that the reviews about eco-friendliness and service quality affect the perception that tourists from Singapore have towards hotels. In Nepal, over 70% of travelers checked online reviews before booking, indicating that both the tone of reviews, positive or negative, and the number of reviews strongly affect booking decisions.

Other researchers have explored how the format of reviews impacts consumer decisions and it was also established that reviews with positive valence have the ability to improve booking confidence (Yuan & Xu, 2024). In one such study, researchers discovered that positive reviews greatly influence students when selecting a hotel. It seems even younger travelers make choices based on online information regarding where to book their stays (Lim et al., 2022b). Positive feedback from guests can lead to higher customer satisfaction and thus, more visits (Y. J. Kim & Kim, 2022). Again, Wardianti & Hidayah (2023) established that hotels

that post attractive images with positive reviews on sites such as Tiket.com are linked with increased intentions to book, thereby establishing that with improved multimedia-enhanced reviews, there is an increased influence. Also, more succinct reviews help travelers to make better decisions as they curb information overload (Fan et al., 2021).

Indeed, Trust acts as the principal connector between information receipt and booking decisions. The more a customer trusts that reviews are genuinely left, the more willing that person is to make reservations (Helen et al., 2021; Zahidah & Rostiani, 2021). Sumarjan et al. (2024) stated that perceptions of review credibility would exert a more substantial effect on booking intentions than perceptions of price. Users feel more confident about their booking when they consider reviews to be honest and comprehensive (Zhang et al., 2022). These findings show that the effects of online reviews may not be limited to the mere transfer of information or the enhancement of emotional states; they may also enhance trusting of the reviews that one reads and a belief that they are not fake.

Hotel reviews that are to be found online make the potential guests feel comfortable and, at the same time, give them information about the hotel's facilities and prices. According to the authors, the quality of service is one of the main determinants people choose to travel (Y. Chen et al., 2022). Likewise, established that the number and quality of reviews are the main factors for people's acceptance of online hotel booking platforms at the same time, they pointed out that review factors do not play a significant role in the connection between booking intention and actual booking behavior. It implies that reviews affect the traveler's plan rather than their final reservation decisions.

The reviewed literature has indicated that online reviews play a significant role in the hotel booking decisions of travelers. Reviews have been an essential source of information for influencing buying behavior, and at the same time, have caused some uncertainty in consumer judgment. How reviews are written, presented, and perceived in terms of their trustworthiness impacts the way people perceive their credibility. Clear, detailed, and coherent reviews instill confidence and satisfaction in the hotel experience. It is thus crucial to understand how travelers interpret and respond to reviews under different conditions and locations, such as the local setting of Butuan City, especially given that its traveler backgrounds may be quite unlike those of larger tourism markets.

Perceived Value

Perceived value has become a central determinant of hotel booking intention, especially as digital platforms shape travelers' evaluations of service quality. Recent studies demonstrate that website aesthetics, interactivity, and ease of use significantly enhance perceived value by creating smooth, engaging, and trustworthy online booking experiences (Garcia et al., 2025). Online reviews likewise strengthen perceived value by providing credible, detailed, and user-generated insights that reduce uncertainty and inform consumers' expectations (Kajornatthapol et al., 2024; Du & He, 2025). Contemporary research highlights perceived value as a multidimensional construct, primarily functional, emotional, and economic in nature, that guides travelers' judgments in digital purchasing environments. As consumers assess these perceived benefits against potential costs, perceived value emerges as a strong predictor of satisfaction and booking intention.

Emerging literature also identifies emotional factors as influential antecedents of perceived value. Hope, for example, increases travelers' perceptions of emotional, economic, and quality-related value when evaluating hotels online, demonstrating that value formation extends beyond rational assessments (Fazal-e-Hasan et al., 2024). Review credibility and reviewer expertise further amplify perceived value by enhancing travelers' confidence in available information, which in turn increases the perceived usefulness of reviews and booking likelihood (Du & He, 2025). Studies consistently affirm that higher perceived value leads to greater trust, satisfaction, and stronger behavioral intentions in digital hotel booking contexts (Garcia et al., 2025; Kajornatthapol et al., 2024). By integrating website experience, emotional expectations, and online review characteristics, perceived value stands as the primary cognitive mechanism linking online information environments to booking decisions. Collectively, these findings underscore the strategic importance of enhancing perceived value to influence consumer choice in an increasingly digital hospitality marketplace.

Perceived Quality

Perceived quality plays an essential role in shaping travelers' booking intentions, especially when decisions rely on online information. Recent studies emphasize that online reviews serve as a major source for assessing hotel quality because they provide firsthand accounts of service performance, staff behavior, cleanliness, and overall guest experience (Ndruru, 2021). When online reviews consistently portray a hotel positively, consumers tend to perceive the establishment as high quality, which strengthens their confidence and influences their intention to book. Research also shows that customers rely on positive reviews as credible

indicators of service reliability and overall excellence, especially in digital environments where physical inspection is not possible (Wen et al., 2025). As customers form perceptions of quality based on others' shared experiences, their booking decisions are guided by these perceived standards. Therefore, perceived quality becomes an important factor that helps travelers evaluate hotels and make informed choices.

Perceived quality is also linked to customer satisfaction and repeat booking behavior in both hospitality and e-commerce settings. Kumar et al. (2025) found that perceived quality is multidimensional, involving both product-related and service-related cues that shape the overall evaluation of a brand. Higher perceived quality leads to stronger satisfaction, which in turn increases booking or repurchase intention. In online hotel booking contexts, reviews that reflect positive service quality experiences enhance trust and strengthen customers' willingness to choose the hotel (Wen et al., 2025). Customers also tend to prioritize hotels that consistently receive high-quality feedback, viewing them as safer and more reliable options. Overall, the literature shows that perceived quality—formed heavily through online reviews—directly influences travelers' booking decisions by shaping their expectations, trust, and satisfaction

Risk Perception

Risk perception has become an important factor affecting consumers' willingness to book or purchase services online. It refers to the fear of possible negative outcomes, such as payment errors, data breaches, or receiving poor service during online transactions (Gu et al., 2021). When consumers feel that an online platform is unsafe or unclear about its processes, their perceived risk increases and reduces their likelihood of making a booking. Recent studies

show that risk perception is strongly linked to uncertainty, especially in digital environments where buyers cannot physically inspect products or services. Anggraeni and Albari (2024) found that even when online reviews help reduce some uncertainty, lower perceived risk alone does not guarantee higher repurchase intention. This highlights that risk perception can discourage online decisions, but it works together with other factors like trust and platform reliability.

In the sharing and online service economy, risk perception is shaped by elements such as platform security, quality of facilities, and interactions among users and service providers. Gu et al. (2021) reported that consumers who face unclear information, unfamiliar social environments, or weak platform safeguards tend to perceive higher risk, leading to lower satisfaction and reduced willingness to revisit. Their study also showed that improving relationships between stakeholders and ensuring high-quality facilities can ease risk concerns. Similarly, Anggraeni and Albari (2024) emphasized that lowering perceived risk is not enough, online platforms must also build strong trust and provide consistent, error-free services to encourage booking or repurchase intention. When risk perception is high, customers hesitate to commit due to fears of loss or disappointment. Overall, the literature confirms that controlling and reducing perceived risk is essential for improving consumers' booking intention in online service settings.

Related Studies

Many studies examining their influence on customers' decisions when booking hotels online include online reviews, website design, and customer trust. According to Huseynov & Güler (2021), positive and negative reviews help strengthen information credibility and enable

consumers to feel confident when booking a hotel. Moreover, detailed, comprehensive, helpful, and accurate reviews will inspire booking, while unclear or negative reviews will discourage it (Widjanarko et al., 2023) Findings such as these surely highlight that reviews are not just feedback but also a tool for customers in making their accommodation choices. In other words, whether people trust what they read online will determine whether they go through with a booking.

According to Thanapotivirat & Jithpakdeepornrat (2022) state that a strong brand image and fair pricing contribute to building trust, which increases the likelihood of customers making bookings. Additionally, residents of Bangkok are more inclined to book online when they perceive the booking systems as fair and reliable (Anutarawaykin et al., 2023). Service quality and brand loyalty also make people likely to book hotels online (Mallare & Guhao, 2020). In Malaysia, the number and reliability of reviews affect booking decisions more than their positivity (Lim et al., 2022c).

Usability and design also play a vital role in building customer trust, which is essential for a website to secure bookings. According to de Vries & Poelhuis (2024), customers are most likely to book on hotel websites that are easy to use, clear, and safe. Conversely, slow or confusing websites make customers less trusting and switch to other platforms. Studies have further confirmed that mobile-friendly designs and apparent pricing increase direct bookings. The quality, advantages, and online reviews of a website have a significant impact on a person's intention to book as well as their actual booking behavior, according to a study on hotel booking platforms (Salameh et al., 2022). Similar to this, the transparency and tone of internet reviews

can influence how guests perceive a hotel and raise the quantity of confirmed reservations (Sumarjan et al., 2024c) A global study published in also found that verified guest reviews and hotel responses foster help build trust and encourage guests to book again. These studies show that transparency, reliability, and a well-designed website are important for building customer trust and keeping them engaged.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

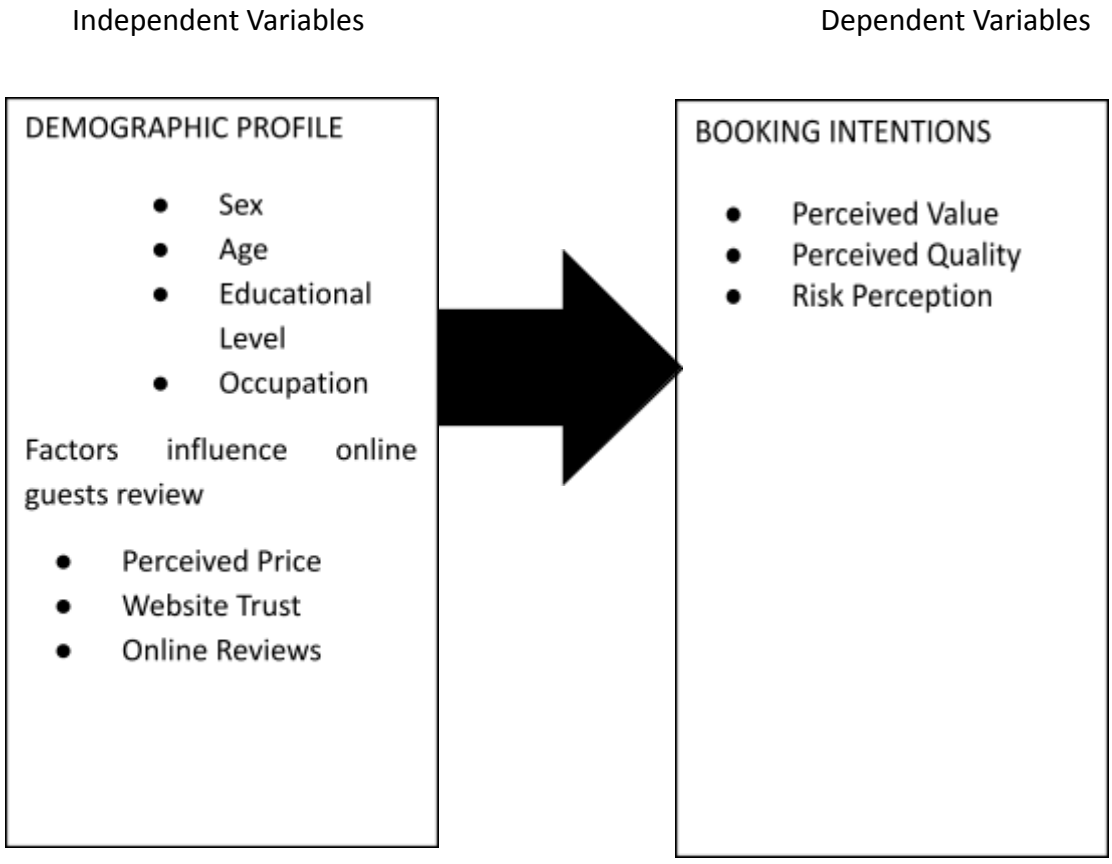


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram showed the interplay between the Independent and Dependent Variables of the Study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem / Objectives of the Study

This study will explore the effects of online reviews on hotel booking intentions in Butuan City. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of educational attainment?
2. What is the level of the factors related to online reviews in terms of:

   2.1 Perceived Price (PP)

   2.2 Website Trust (WT)

   2.3 Online Reviews (OR)
3. Is there a significant relationship among the online review factors—Perceived Price (PP), Website Trust (WT), and Online Reviews (OR)?
4. Is there a significant relationship between online review factors (PP, WT, OR) and hotel booking intention (Perceived Value (PV), Perceived Quality (PQ), and Risk Perception (RP))?
5. Does educational attainment significantly relate to hotel booking intention?

1.6 Hypotheses of the Study

The following null hypotheses (H0) will guide the study and will be tested at the 0.05 level of significance:

$H0_1$: There is no significant relationship among the online review factors, namely Perceived Price (PP), Website Trust (WT), and Online Reviews (OR).

$H0_2$: There is no significant relationship between online review factors (PP, WT, OR) and hotel booking intention in terms of Perceived Value (PV), Perceived Quality (PQ), and Risk Perception (RP).

$H0_3$: There is no significant relationship between educational attainment and hotel booking intention among hotel guests in Butuan City.

1.7 Scope and Limitations

This study will focus on examining how perceived price, website trust, and online reviews influence the hotel booking intentions of guests who have previously booked accommodations online in selected hotels within Butuan City, namely Butuan Grand Palace Hotel, Amigotel, Icon Suites & Convention Center, Oasis Hotel, Dottie's Hotel, Hotel Karaga, Luxury Hotel, and Embassy Hotel. It includes both local residents and travelers who completed online reservations using any digital platform, without limiting the source of reviews. Booking intention is assessed through perceived value, perceived quality, and risk perception, alongside demographic factors such as sex, age, educational level, and occupation. The study will gather information through survey responses provided by participants based on their own booking experiences. Because the research will focus only on selected hotels in Butuan City and will be conducted within a specific timeframe, its findings are limited to these conditions and may not reflect all possible booking situations in other settings.



1.8 Definition of Terms

To help readers understand the study better, the following terms are defined as follows:

Age. It refers to the number age refers to the respondent's number of years at the time of the survey and will be grouped into categories to identify differences in hotel booking intentions.

Booking. It refers to the action of reserving a hotel room and will be measured by whether respondents have made an online hotel reservation within the past 12 months.

Booking Intention. It refers to likelihood or willingness to reserve a hotel room after reading online reviews and will be measured using a 4-point Likert scale.

Booking Usage. It refers to the frequency with which respondents book hotel rooms influenced by online reviews and will be measured by how often they make online reservations.

Butuan City. It refers to the geographical location where the study will be conducted and where respondents' hotel booking behaviors will be examined.

Educational Level. It refers to the highest academic qualification completed by the respondents and will be used to analyze its effect on booking intention.

Guest. It refers to an individual who has stayed or will stay in a hotel in Butuan City and who will participate as a respondent in the study.

Hotel. It refers to lodging establishments in Butuan City that provide accommodation services and will be evaluated through online reviews used by respondents in making booking decisions.

Intention. It refers to the respondent's planned or intended action to book a hotel and will be measured through responses to intention-related survey items.

Occupation. It refers to the respondent's current job or employment status and will be measured through self-reported categories in the questionnaire to determine its influence on booking decisions. **Online Reviews.** It refers to ratings, comments, and feedback posted by previous hotel guests on online platforms and will be measured based on respondents' exposure to and reliance on these reviews when booking hotels.

Perceived Price. It refers to the respondent's assessment of hotel room prices as affordable or expensive and will be measured using survey items related to price evaluation.

Sex. It refers to the respondent's recorded gender as male or female and will be used to compare differences in hotel booking intentions.

Tourists. It refers to individuals traveling to Butuan City for business, leisure, or other purposes and will be measured by self-identification and travel purpose.

Website. It refers to online booking platforms or hotel websites that respondents will use to search for hotel information, read reviews, and make reservations.

Website Trust. It refers to the respondent's level of confidence in the security, reliability, and credibility of hotel booking websites and will be measured using trust-related survey statements.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter will discuss the research design, research materials and methods, research environment, population and sample, research data and analysis plan and research ethical standard that will be used in the study.

2.1 Research Design

This study will use a quantitative-descriptive correlational research design to find the relationship between online reviews and intentions to book a hotel in Butuan City. In this design, the study will involve gathering numerical data through survey questionnaires that describe and analyze the perceptions and behaviors of the respondents. The descriptive part will help the researchers in presenting the characteristics of the respondents, while the correlational part will determine if there is a significant relationship between online reviews-such as perceived price, website trust, and review quality-and hotel booking intentions. This design will be appropriate because it will enable the researcher to collect measurable data and find out how online reviews may influence customers' decisions to book hotels in Butuan City.

2.2 Research Locale

The study will be conducted in Butuan City, Agusan del Norte, a highly urbanized center recognized as the commercial and tourism hub of the Caraga Region. Butuan City serves as a major gateway to Caraga Region, attracting a steady flow of travelers for business, government transactions, education, leisure, and cultural tourism. The city will experience notable growth in

its hospitality sector, with numerous hotels and lodging establishments adopting online booking platforms such as Agoda, Booking.com, Facebook Marketplace, and other hotel platforms. This digital integration will make Butuan City a strategic location for examining how online reviews will influence consumer decisions in selecting and booking hotel accommodations. In recent years, the hospitality sector in Butuan City has expanded, with the presence of budget hotels, mid-range accommodations, and business-oriented hotels, many of which have adopted online booking platforms and digital marketing strategies, including the use of websites and social media pages. The locale will be chosen because it represents an emerging market where technological advancement intersects with tourism development, and the presence of both local and international travelers, coupled with the increasing reliance on digital feedback systems, will provide an appropriate environment for assessing the relationship between online reviews and hotel booking intentions, while conducting the study in Butuan City will allow an in-depth understanding of consumer behavior within a regional context that mirrors broader trends in the tourism and hospitality industry.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

This study will be conducted in Butuan City, one of the highly urbanized cities in the Caraga Region known for its growing hospitality and tourism industry. The respondents are the hotel guests of eight selected hotels, namely Butuan Grand Palace Hotel, Amigotel, Icon Suites & Convention Center, Oazis Hotel, Dottie's Hotel, Prince Hotel, Luxury Hotel, and Embassy Hotel. The sampling of participants was determined based on the actual population of hotel guests who completed online bookings in the selected hotels in Butuan City from July to September

2025. Official booking records provided by the participating hotels indicated a total population of 5,679 guests during this period. This population served as the basis for identifying eligible respondents who had direct experience with online hotel booking platforms and online reviews.

A sample size of 285 respondents was deemed adequate to represent the population while ensuring manageability of data collection. The distribution of respondents per hotel was proportionally allocated according to each hotel's share of the total guest population. This proportional allocation ensured that hotels with higher guest volumes contributed a larger number of respondents, while smaller hotels were still represented fairly in the sample. Convenience sampling was employed due to accessibility constraints and the voluntary nature of participation only guests who were available and willing to respond during the data collection period were included.

The use of convenience sampling was appropriate for this study because the target respondents hotel guests with prior online booking experience were already present within the research environment. This approach allowed the researchers to efficiently gather relevant data while maintaining alignment with the study's objectives. The sampling method ensured that participants possessed firsthand knowledge of online reviews, perceived price, website trust, and booking intention, which are central to the variables under investigation. The number of respondents per hotel will be allocated as follows: Butuan Grand Palace Hotel (116), Amigotel (12), Icon Suites & Convention Center (14), Oazis Hotel (12), Dottie's Hotel (64), Prince Hotel (21), Luxury Hotel (29), and Embassy Hotel (19).

Table 1. Population of Respondents

HOTELS	JULY	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	TOTAL	SAMPLE	PERCENTAGE
Butuan Grand Palace hotel	709	668	943	2,320	116	40.7
Amigotel	92	76	68	236	12	4.2
Icon Suites & Convention Center	95	100	85	280	14	4.9
Oazis Hotel	70	80	85	235	12	4.2
Dottie's Hotel	551	421	300	1,272	64	22.5
Prince Hotel	143	149	136	428	21	7.4
Luxury Hotel	120	250	200	570	29	10.2
Embassy Hotel	109	98	131	338	17	6.0
Total	**1,889**	**1,842**	**1948**	**5,679**	**285**	**100**

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Research Instrument

The research instrument for this study will be a structured survey questionnaire adapted from two primary sources: the study of Augustine and Adnan (2025) entitled *"The Effects of Perceived Price, Website Trust, and Online Reviews on Online Hotel Booking Intention in Kuala Lumpur,"* and the study of Arniel Jr. Edmedulan (2025) entitled *"Impact of Online Customer Reviews on Booking Intentions and Customer Trust Among Hotels in Region X: Basis of a Framework for Enhancing Customer Booking Intention and Trust."* These frameworks were selected because they align directly with the variables of the present research and have been proven effective in assessing online hotel booking behaviors. The questionnaire will be contextualized to reflect the hotel environment and online review practices relevant to consumers in Butuan City. Contextual modifications include the rewording of selected items for clarity, adjustment of terminology to suit the online hotel booking context, and removal of

items not applicable to the local research setting, while maintaining the theoretical foundations of the original instruments.

The instrument will consist of three parts: Part I will gather demographic information, including sex, age, educational level, and occupation. Part II will assess the online review–related factors identified by Augustine and Adnan, particularly Perceived Price (PP), Website Trust (WT), and Online Reviews (OR). Perceived price is operationalized through indicators related to price fairness, affordability, and value for money, while website trust is measured using indicators such as website reliability, transaction security, and information credibility. Online reviews are assessed through indicators including review credibility, review valence, review quantity, and perceived usefulness. Part III will adopt Edmedulan's components of booking intention, focusing on Perceived Value (PV), Perceived Quality (PQ), and Risk Perception (RP) as indicators of online booking intention. All items will be measured using a four-point Likert scale ranging from 4 (Strongly Agree) to 1 (Strongly Disagree) ensuring the data collected will be analyzed using descriptive and inferential statistics to determine how online review factors and booking intention components influence hotel booking decisions among consumers in Butuan City.

Statistical Treatment

In presenting, analyzing, and interpreting data, the researcher used the following statistical test, namely.

Frequency and Percentage Computation – to describe the respondents' demographic profile (SOP 1).

Mean – to determine the external factors in terms of perceived price, website trust and online reviews. (SOP 2).

Correlational Analysis – to determine significant relationships between online reviews and hotel booking intentions. (SOP 3).

Correlational Analysis – to determine significant relationships between booking intention, perceived price, website trust, and online reviews. (SOP 4).

2.5 Ethical Standards

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Right

The information that will be gathered from respondents will be kept highly confidential and well-protected to avoid misconception regarding this research. The respondents will be given code names to hide their personal information to secure their identity. This study adheres to the Data Privacy Act of the Philippines, and the data being gathered will purely be used only in this research study.

B. Informed Consent

The respondents will be guests who have booked hotels online in selected hotels in Butuan City, Agusan del Norte. The respondents will undergo a brief orientation to be conducted by the researchers to help them understand the purpose of the study, as well as its potential benefits and risks before agreeing to participate. The respondents will be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time without any explanation or penalty. During the orientation, a written consent form will be distributed to each respondent to ensure that



they fully understand their rights and responsibilities as participants. Signing the form will indicate their voluntary agreement to participate in the study.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

Personal data that will be collected, including the demographic profile of the respondents, will be handled with strict confidentiality and only with the respondents' explicit consent through an informed consent form. All data will be anonymized to protect respondents' identities. The set of questionnaires will be administered under the supervision of the researchers to ensure the confidentiality of the respondents. Only the researchers will have access to the code that links identification numbers to the respondents. All data collected will be handled with the highest level of confidentiality, ensuring that the respondents' privacy will be fully protected throughout the research process.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

Participation in the study will be voluntary. Respondents in the study will be informed of their right to withdraw without any negative consequences. No animals will be involved in this study; therefore, the consideration of alternatives to animal use will not be applicable.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

The researchers will engage with the respondents respectfully and professionally to establish a safe and supportive environment throughout the study. If any risks will be associated, respondents will be referred to the appropriate support services to ensure their well-being, such as the clinic and Guidance Office for assistance if needed during the research process. After participation, researchers will provide a debriefing session to ensure no physical,

psychological, or emotional harm will occur throughout the research process. The study will not involve animal subjects, the 3Rs principles of replacement, reduction, and refinement will have no application.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

This study will provide a better understanding of how online reviews, perceived price, and website trust will influence hotel guests' booking intentions in Butuan City. The findings will be shared upon request of the respondents and participating hotels. The results will help improve hotel services, enhance customer trust, and strengthen online marketing strategies.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

This study will ensure justice and fairness in participant selection by using clear and appropriate inclusion criteria aligned with the research objectives. Respondents will consist of local and tourist hotel guests in Butuan City who are 18 years old and above, have used online booking platforms, and have read online reviews prior to booking. Participants will be selected without discrimination in terms of gender, nationality, or background, ensuring equal opportunity to participate. Individuals who have not used online booking platforms or have not read online reviews will be excluded to maintain the relevance and fairness of the data collected.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Data collection and analysis will be conducted using standardized methods to ensure accurate and reliable results. Initially, the researchers will submit a formal request to the following selected hotels to obtain the complete list of eligible respondents for the study. All

findings will undergo careful review to avoid potential bias or error, and no limitations will be identified in the study.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The findings of the study will be reported honestly, with no manipulation or alteration of data. All sources such as academic references will be properly cited and acknowledged to ensure respect for intellectual property rights and uphold ethical research standards. This study will utilize some AI tools to support various aspects of the research. There will be no potential conflict of interest involved in the study.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

No patented materials will be involved in this study. All copyrighted materials including references will be properly cited in accordance with intellectual property laws. The researchers will ensure that all sources will be appropriately acknowledged, maintaining academic integrity and avoiding any form of plagiarism.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The researchers will inform the respondents about the possible risks and potential benefits of the study, ensuring that an informed consent form will be provided. If any significant risks will be associated, such as emotional, physical, or psychological, appropriate health monitoring programs and emotional support services will be available.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Related Technologies

The researchers will utilize digital technologies throughout the research process, including finding reliable articles to maintain the accuracy and credibility of the study. AI tools,

such as ChatGPT, will be utilized to assist in summarizing statements and enhancing the quality of the study. Platforms like Google Scholar, Elicit, and Typeset.io will be used to find supporting studies, ensuring the reliability and credibility of the research. Additionally, Grammarly will be used to ensure that the research report will adhere to proper grammar and clarity standards. The responsible use of technologies will help maintain the integrity of the study.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

The research will obtain ethical approval from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga, confirming its compliance with all relevant guidelines on respondents' protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

Data Gathering Procedure

In gathering the data, the researchers will begin by sending a formal request letter to the managers of the selected hotels in Butuan City to secure approval for the conduct of the study. Once all necessary permissions are obtained, the researchers will finalize the research instrument, which will be anchored on the studies of Augustine and Adnan (2025), titled “The Effects of Perceived Price, Website Trust, and Online Reviews on Online Hotel Booking Intention in Kuala Lumpur,” and Arniel Jr. Edmedulan (2025), titled “Impact of Online Customer Reviews on Booking Intentions and Customer Trust Among Hotels in Region X: Basis of a Framework for Enhancing Customer Booking Intention and Trust.” The instrument will undergo expert validation to ensure clarity, accuracy, and relevance to the objectives of the study. After validation, pilot testing will be conducted, and the results will be submitted to a statistician to determine the reliability and finalize the questionnaire. Once the instrument is validated and

completed, the researchers will coordinate with each participating hotel to schedule data collection. During the scheduled visits, the questionnaires will be administered to the selected respondents, ensuring voluntary participation and strict adherence to ethical research standards. After data collection, the responses will be tallied, encoded, and organized for statistical processing. The encoded data will then be submitted to the statistician to ensure computational accuracy, verify data quality, and generate statistical tables aligned with the study variables. Finally, the researchers will analyze, interpret, and discuss the findings based on the statement of the problem and the study domains: perceived value, perceived quality, and risk perception. The results will be synthesized to draw conclusions and formulate recommendations regarding the preparedness of hotels in Butuan City.

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